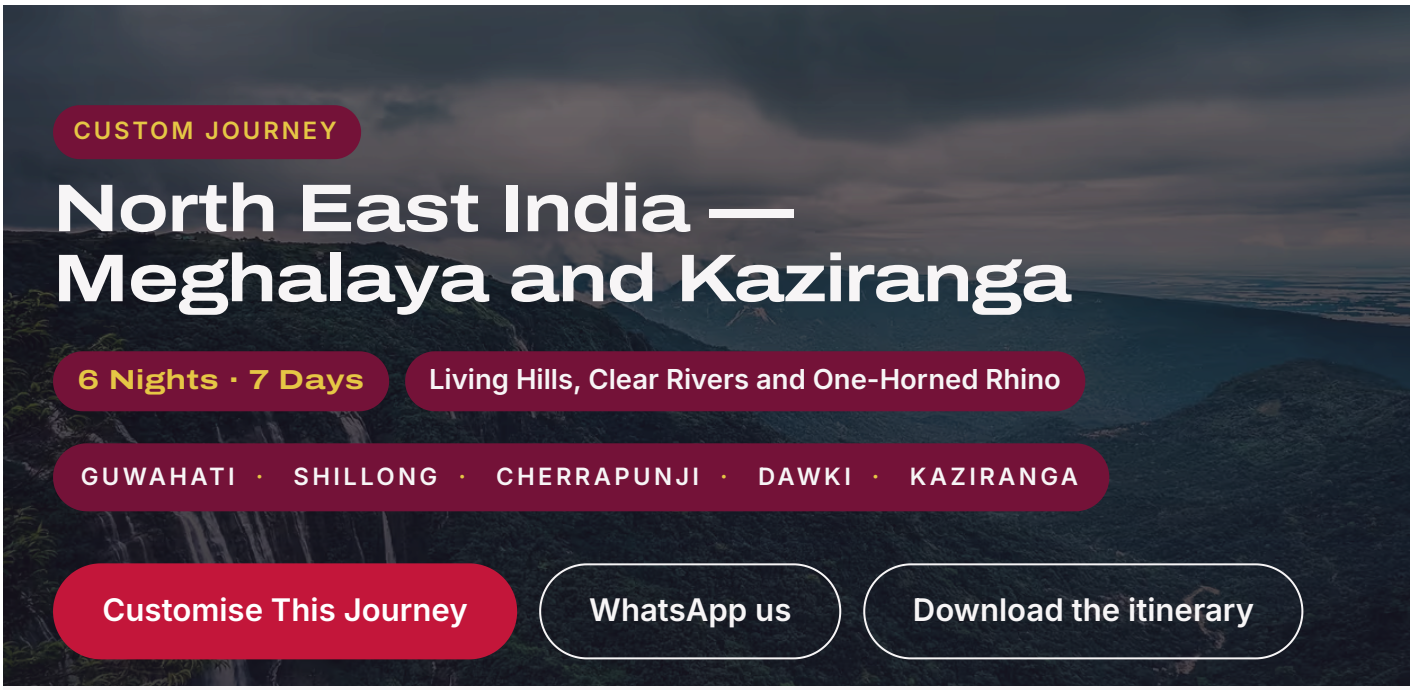
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https://india-visit-website.pages.dev/journeys/north-east-india-6n-7d/



DURATION
6 Nights · 7 Days

ROUTE
Guwahati return

PACE
Moderate

BEST SEASON
October to April

IDEAL FOR
Couples, Families, Groups

Most first trips to India go west and south. This one goes east, into the seven states that sit beyond the narrow corridor of land connecting them to the rest of the country — and into landscapes that look nothing like the India of the brochures.

Meghalaya means “abode of clouds”, and it earns the name: gorges and plunge waterfalls, limestone caves, and a river at Dawki so clear that the boats on it appear to be suspended in air. Then the road drops back down to the Brahmaputra plains and Kaziranga, where two-thirds of the world’s one-horned rhinoceros live in grass tall enough to hide an elephant. Seven days, one long driving day, and a part of the country that very few visitors reach.

Journey Highlights

- **Begin** on the banks of the Brahmaputra at Guwahati, with an evening climb to the Kamakhya Temple above the river.
- **Rise** into the Khasi Hills to Shillong, the "Scotland of the East", stopping at the vast Umiam Lake on the way up.
- **Stand** at Nohkalikai Falls near Cherrapunji, one of India's tallest plunge waterfalls, in one of the wettest places on earth.
- **Enter** the cool limestone chambers of Mawsmai Cave, and take in the seven-stream cascade at the Seven Sisters viewpoint.
- **Drift** on the Umngot river at Dawki, so clear that the boats appear to hang in mid-air above the riverbed.
- **Track** the one-horned rhinoceros by jeep through Kaziranga's elephant grass — a UNESCO site and the species' great stronghold.
- **Return** along the Brahmaputra floodplains, with the river in view for most of the drive back to Guwahati.

Itinerary at a Glance

DAY	DESTINATION	SIGNATURE EXPERIENCE
Day 01	**Guwahati**	Arrive on the Brahmaputra; Kamakhya Temple at dusk
Day 02	**Shillong**	Up into the Khasi Hills, with Umiam Lake en route
Day 03	**Cherrapunji**	Nohkalikai Falls, Mawsmai Cave, Seven Sisters viewpoint
Day 04	**Dawki**	Boating the transparent Umngot river on the border

DAY	DESTINATION	SIGNATURE EXPERIENCE
Day 05	**Kaziranga**	Down to the Assam plains and the edge of the park
Day 06	**Kaziranga**	Morning jeep safari among the one-horned rhino
Day 07	**Departure**	The Brahmaputra road back to Guwahati

Day by Day

Expand all

Day 01 Guwahati — On the Brahmaputra

The journey begins on the banks of one of the few rivers in the world to carry a masculine name. Guwahati is a working city where wide river views meet ordinary bustle, and it makes an easy, unhurried start. In the evening, up Nilachal Hill to the Kamakhya Temple, one of the oldest Shakti shrines in India, with the river and the city spread out below as the light goes.

Overnight in Guwahati

Day 02 Into the Hills — Guwahati to Shillong

Drive — about 3 hours

Three hours of steady climbing out of the plains and into pine country. Shillong has been called the Scotland of the East since the British named it that, and the rolling greens and persistent mist make the comparison less lazy than it sounds. Stop at Umiam Lake on the way, a wide reservoir ringed by hills. The evening is best spent around Police Bazaar, which is where Shillong actually is when it is not being looked at.

Overnight in Shillong

Day 03 Cherrapunji — Gorges, Falls and Limestone

Drive — about 1.5 hours

Deeper into Khasi Hills country to Cherrapunji, known locally as Sohra and internationally as one of the wettest inhabited places on earth. The landscape is the consequence: sheer gorges, plunging waterfalls and caves hollowed out of limestone. Nohkalikai is among the tallest plunge falls in India, dropping into a green pool from the edge of the plateau; Mawsmai Cave is cool, close and walkable; and the Seven Sisters viewpoint takes in seven streams falling down one cliff face at once.

Overnight in Shillong

Day 04 Dawki — A River You Can See Through

Drive — day trip

A day trip to Dawki on the Bangladesh border, where the Umngot river runs over pale limestone so clear that boats appear to be floating in air. The effect is best in the dry months, when the water is at its lowest and stillest, and best early, before the light gets hard. An hour on the water is plenty. Back up to Shillong for the night.

Overnight in Shillong

Day 05 Down to the Plains — Shillong to Kaziranga

Drive — 5 to 6 hours

The longest drive of the trip, and the one that earns this itinerary its moderate rather than relaxed rating: five to six hours back down out of the hills and east along the Assam plains to Kaziranga National Park. A UNESCO World Heritage Site on the Brahmaputra floodplain, Kaziranga holds roughly two-thirds of the world's remaining one-horned rhinoceros. Check in near the park and settle in early — tomorrow starts before dawn.

Overnight near Kaziranga

Day 06 Kaziranga — Grassland and Rhino

A full day given to the park. The morning jeep safari goes out through elephant grass that stands well above the vehicle, into a mosaic of grassland and wetland that supports rhino, wild buffalo, swamp deer and, if the day is generous, tiger — Kaziranga has one of the highest tiger densities anywhere, though seeing one is luck rather than planning. The afternoon is free; there is usually the option of a gentle nature walk around the property as the light softens.

Overnight near Kaziranga

Day 07 Kaziranga — Departure

Drive — 4 to 5 hours

A last morning at the park's edge, then the drive back west to Guwahati along the Brahmaputra, with the river in view for most of it, in time for your onward flight.

Departure

Practical notes

Getting there

Guwahati (GAU) has direct flights from most major Indian cities and is the natural gateway for the whole region.

Permits

No Inner Line Permit is required for Meghalaya or Assam for Indian nationals. Foreign nationals should confirm current requirements with us before booking.

Best time to visit

October to April. Kaziranga closes for the monsoon, roughly May to October, so the park half of this itinerary is not possible outside that window.

Pace

Moderate. Comfortable throughout except for one long transfer day from Shillong down to Kaziranga.

Getting around

A private car with a driver is the only practical way to cover this route; public transport between these points is slow and infrequent.